Daniel Scherzer

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Open-source software developer with over a decade of coding experience. Expert in multiple programming languages from all parts of a technical stack. Track record of delivering results on a deadline. Excellent communications and customer-facing skills; sought-after conference presenter. Team player and leader. See blog at https://scherzer.dev/Blog.

Open-Source Experience

- Contributions available at https://github.com/DanielEScherzer
- PHP core developer, PHP 8.5 and PHP 8.6 release manager, ext/reflection maintainer
- Author of multiple RFCs for major PHP features; RFCs accepted and included in PHP 8.5 and PHP 8.6
- Multiple libraries published on packagist (https://packagist.org/packages/danielescherzer)

Professional Experience

PHP Foundation Ecosystem Security Team (September 2026 – present)

- Triaging and addressing issues reported to the security team out of scope of the project's security policy.

Freelance developer/independent contractor (various clients) (July 2026 – present)

- PDF analysis and cleanup using Rust and LaTeX.
- Development of a database integration API using Python and Microsoft SQL Server.

Technical Project Manager, WikiTeq (January 2023 – May 2026)

- Coordinating a team of developers from around the world to develop and maintain client sites running MediaWiki.
- Spearheaded adoption of Infrastructure as Code with Puppet.
- Liaison between developers and clients, translating between user stories and technical requirements.
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt certification earned for increasing speed of task reviews
    - 90% reviewed within a week (all priority levels)
    - 100% reviewed within two weeks (all but one priority level)
- Public code contributions available at https://github.com/DanielButAtWork.

Sound engineer and theater crew, freelance (2022 – present)

- Experience working with fast-paced production requirements.
- Understanding that perfect is the enemy of good – the show must go on!
- Role flexibility to ensure the best overall result – working on spotlights, sound effects, projections, backstage run crew, light cues, and other roles as needed.

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Skills

Programming in PHP, C, Rust, Python, JavaScript, C++, Java, Lua (and more); quick to learn new languages
Tools: Git, Docker, Composer, Kubernetes, Puppet, NPM, Pip, Cargo (and others)
Excellent written communication (including technical writing) and oral communication (including over Zoom)
Experience working collaboratively with diverse teams, including remotely
Organization and technical project management

Selected Conference Presentations

- [keynote] "PHP2Shell: Tales from the Front Lines," *ConFoo Montreal 2027*. Montreal, Canada. February 2027. (upcoming)
- "From First PR to Release Manager: A Path into Open Source," *FOSSY 2026*. Vancouver, Canada. August 2026.
- "PHP 8.6: The Inside Scoop"
    - *ConFoo Montreal 2027*. Montreal, Canada. February 2027. (upcoming)
    - *MergePHP*. Remote. November 2026.
    - *Longhorn PHP Conference*. Austin, Texas. October 2026.
    - *PHP Tek 2026*. Chicago, Illinois. May 2026.
- "Semantic Versioning and the PHP Ecosystem: A Reality Check," *PHP Tek 2026*. Chicago, Illinois. May 2026.
- "Closing the Loop," *MediaWiki Users and Developers Conference, Spring 2026*. Salt Lake City, Utah. March 2026.
- "Introducing MixedVisibilityFiles," *MediaWiki Users and Developers Conference, Spring 2026*. Salt Lake City, Utah. March 2026.
- "Intro to Rust for Experienced Software Developers," *ConFoo Montreal 2026*. Montreal, Canada. February 2026.
- "PHP 8.5: New Features from the Source," *ConFoo Montreal 2026*. Montreal, Canada. February 2026.

Education

- Master of Science (Tufts University)
    - Master of Computer Science program
    - GPA 3.9/4.0
- Bachelor of Science (Tufts University, *magna cum laude*, Highest Honors in Thesis)
    - Double major in Computer Science and Political Science
    - Minor in Theatre, Dance, and Performance Studies
    - GPA 3.8/4.0 (Dean's List), National Merit Scholarship recipient
    - Member, Pi Sigma Alpha (National Political Science Honor Society)

Languages

English (native speaker); Hebrew (fluent); Chinese (conversational); Spanish (conversational)